Name: RISK 4.1 - disinformation, surveillance, influence at scale

<Files\\Processed x Highly relevant\\2024-05-16 - STF - Tova podcast- I would never gi> - § 6 references coded [8.71% Coverage]

Reference 1 - 1.51% Coverage

The cyber-security expert is the co-founder of Australian company Internet 2.0, which cracked the code to TikTok and revealed just how much data itâ€™s collecting from us - and how different that is to what TikTok says itâ€™s collecting.
â€œTikT

Reference 2 - 1.15% Coverage

the app queries the location of the user regularly, they actually called it super location in the app, which is not just where you are in terms of GPS, but also your altitude.â€
He says

Reference 3 - 0.99% Coverage

â€œSo if you can't even trust the app not to misuse the functionality, what chance have we got stopping the Chinese government from
using that functionality?â€

Reference 4 - 1.79% Coverage

Potter says the app also collects all of the contacts in the phone, â€œso you can imagine just how dangerous that is for a Member of Parliament who may have, you know, incredibly private, mobile phone numbers on their phone. And sharing that with the application poses a significant risk.â€
I

Reference 5 - 1.14% Coverage

Asked if New Zealand believes that TikTokâ€™s data is being passed on, accessed or manipulated by the Chinese Communist Party, the Prime Minister told the Tova podcast he had no comment.

Reference 6 - 2.14% Coverage

â€œIf you're a dissident from China who's living in New Zealand, if you're a minority from China who lives in New Zealand, if you've spoken out against China and you live in New Zealand, you're not welcome on that platform. And I think there is something negative about taking part in an ecosystem that normalises censorship and exclusion like that.â€

<Files\\Processed x Highly relevant\\2024-05-19 - RNZ - Police use images from number> - § 2 references coded [4.15% Coverage]

Reference 1 - 2.00% Coverage

The extensive use of automated number plate recognition (ANPR) by police last year sparked a legal challenge which is ongoing.

Reference 2 - 2.15% Coverage

Police were forced to audit their use of ANPR - and found very isolated cases of misuse - and introduced better training, two years ago.

<Files\\Processed x Highly relevant\\2024-06-05 - RNZ - Software for new supermarket b> - § 1 reference coded [3.04% Coverage]

Reference 1 - 3.04% Coverage

A legal challenge against police over their growing use of ANPR has been mounted in the district court, with the Public Defence Service arguing this should require a warrant.
The police told RNZ they did not keep track of the types of cameras footage came from, so did not have any specific details or statistics.

<Files\\Processed x Highly relevant\\2024-06-20 - RNZ - New AI video tech- It brings a> - § 4 references coded [10.68% Coverage]

Reference 1 - 1.17% Coverage

A breakthrough AI tool that can make fake videos has experts worried about a new generation of misinformation.

Reference 2 - 3.22% Coverage

"I do worry about what people will fall for on social media. If you look at things that have happened like Trump and Brexit, the amount of people who were influenced by what they believed to be the truth on social media... if things like [Dream Machine] are out there it's just going to make it worse."

Reference 3 - 4.28% Coverage

But she said the technology was improving rapidly and artificial videos were becoming harder to identify.
"The issue is [the AI] keeps getting better, politically you could do anything... Chris Luxon's face is incredibly out there in the public, there's videos of him speaking and doing things," she said. "You could make him do anything with AI, and that's pretty dangerous for a political figure."

Reference 4 - 2.01% Coverage

"We saw OpenAI's latest Sora model, they held it back from public access because they were concerned about it. So seeing this one from Luma is quite interesting and raises some challenges."

<Files\\Processed x Highly relevant\\2024-07-03 - RNZ - AI for school tutoring, instan> - § 1 reference coded [1.62% Coverage]

Reference 1 - 1.62% Coverage

But we have to also be aware that some people might misuse AI and we have to be ready for that too."

Using voice cloning technology in scams or disinformation and deep fakes to influence opinion were examples of this.

<Files\\Processed x Highly relevant\\2024-07-16 - RNZ - Government checks for bias in> - § 1

reference coded [1.62% Coverage]

Reference 1 - 1.62% Coverage

Whatever its accuracy, the debate remains fierce about its spread, and over whether or how to use facial recognition in public spaces.

<Files\\Processed x Highly relevant\\2024-08-11 - RNZ - The surveilled society- Who is> - § 6 references coded [10.80% Coverage]

Reference 1 - 3.11% Coverage

It has proceeded apace, with barely a blip - though just this week a legal challenge to it has been playing out in the Auckland District Court, without any coverage by the media.
In that hearing, expected to involve at least four separate criminal cases challenging police use for evidence of footage gathered without a warrant from CCTV retail cameras linked to automated number plate recognition (ANPR) systems, the ruling was reserved.

Reference 2 - 1.82% Coverage

Another wee blip came after RNZ reported last year that new billboards at Wellington's train stations would sport cameras from the same Swedish company that supplies surveillance products to China. In a quick-about, the billboard company ditched the cameras.

Reference 3 - 0.95% Coverage

Many of the camera systems could run facial recognition (FR). Sometimes you are just asked to trust the FR function is not switched on.

Reference 4 - 0.54% Coverage

Cameras are not quite the least of surveillance, but are only one part of it.

Reference 5 - 2.73% Coverage

Another is the spread of systems that do not rely on cameras but surveil anyway, collecting data on you about where you go and what you do, and storing it and possibly sharing it, under agreements and contracts aimed at protecting your privacy and keeping your profile from becoming a tradeable commodity, though that has not worked so well elsewhere, such as on social media platforms.

Reference 6 - 1.64% Coverage

Again, it is convenient, and the proliferation of this new type of SaaS did not get in the way of New Zealand recently signing up to a USled 'Joint statement on efforts to counter the proliferation and misuse of commercial spyware'.

<Files\\Processed x Highly relevant\\2024-08-20 - RNZ - NZ Police finally has facial r> - § 2 references coded [4.52% Coverage]

Reference 1 - 1.61% Coverage

Globally, police use of facial recognition is spreading, often provoking controversy, such as in the UK,

where it is boosting its deployment to curb far-right riots this month, against the protests of two dozen human rights groups.

Reference 2 - 2.91% Coverage

The new, six-page policy said FRT's use would be "approved, controlled, monitored, and governed", with internal auditing where possible, and only deployed on images police have lawful access to. "This policy ensures that appropriate safeguards are in place for Police's use of FRT and the storage of personal information, and that use of FRT is lawful, proportionate, and appropriate in a New Zealand policing context."

<Files\\Processed x Highly relevant\\2024-08-25 - NZH - War of the AI bots> - § 5 references coded [15.22% Coverage]

Reference 1 - 4.86% Coverage

Disinformation experts say a large artificial intelligence network, including social media accounts pretending to be from New Zealand, aims to disrupt social cohesion in English-speaking democracies.
Cyber security company CyberCX claimed to have unmasked a network of more than 5000 social media accounts created and controlled by artificial intelligence (AI) based in China, which CyberCX terms the â€œGreen Cicadaâ€ network.
CyberCX Intelligence executive director Katherine Mansted said the company believed this was the first public discovery of an â€œAIcontrolled network of disinformationâ€ .

Reference 2 - 4.55% Coverage

â€œThis is ticking so many firsts boxes, in terms of the first China-nexus AI-controlled operation ... the first in terms of being one of the largest networks of co-ordinated inauthentic activity and something that also seems to be popping up where there is global division or elections.â€
The company said it had traced the network to a Chinese-language LLM system, an AI researcher affiliated with a Chinese university and another Chinese AI company.
However, Mansted said a direct link to the Chinese Government had not been proven and was not being alleged.

Reference 3 - 1.35% Coverage

Mansted said the networkâ€™s aim was likely disinformation and misinformation rather than the type of propaganda or persuasion you might have seen during the Cold War.

Reference 4 - 1.55% Coverage

The bots were not necessarily aiming to present one point of view but instead to amplify division, sow distrust in institutions, and make it less possible to debate ideas in the public square.

Reference 5 - 2.91% Coverage

Mansted said this demonstrated a â€œnascent capability for information warfareâ€ .
â€œItâ€™s less about what [AI] has done and more about what it could do, and as New Zealand politics changes, as New Zealandâ€™s relations with other countries change, I think thatâ€™s where we might see this network or indeed others pivot and potentially try and interfere.â€

<Files\\Processed x Highly relevant\\2024-08-29 - RNZ - How your social media posts ar> - § 3

references coded [15.44% Coverage]

Reference 1 - 3.66% Coverage

"Although Meta said in 2023 it's only using public posts to train its AI, its privacy policy says it can use any of the contents on its platforms."
He listed some of the information we consciously - and unconsciously - share with the social media giant: Posts, photos, messages, apps, purchases, interactions, connections, devices, internet service provider, language, location information, and more. "Any of this information can be used to train the AI, but whether it is or not is hard to say. It's challenging to pin down exactly what's happening."
Us

Reference 2 - 2.94% Coverage

And it's not just Meta: "All digital services will collect some sort of data about you. I think it's important for the average New Zealander to realise their data is valuable."
Even deleting social media accounts "doesn't fully protect you from having your data harvested in future", AI lead at public interest think tank Brainbox Allyn Robins told RNZ. "More and more, every single online interaction is being mined for data to train AI."
Whil

Reference 3 - 8.85% Coverage

Europe's General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR), possibly the world's toughest data protection rules, has created obstacles for Meta and other companies looking to improve their models with user-generated material.
In June, Meta confirmed it would delay training its large language models on Facebook and Instagram content from its users in the European Union and United Kingdom.
Ireland's Data Protection Commission, which oversees Meta's compliance with GDPR said it welcomed the decision and would continue to engage with the company.
"The GDPR is kind of a gift in this aspect, because the EU is a large and powerful enough economic force that large companies tend to comply with their regulations rather than abandoning the European market - which means they already have compliance processes for the GDPR built into their systems," Robins said.
But legal solutions are imperfect, he added, noting ongoing lawsuits arguing big chunks of the early data gathering for big AI models like OpenAI's ChatGPT were against not only the GDPR, but a lot of copyright law.
"There's a strong incentive to just grab whatever you can and try to move quickly enough that by the time people start paying attention, you're too big and influential to meaningfully punish for any indiscretions you may have committed on your way to the top."
NZ law

<Files\\Processed x Highly relevant\\2024-09-12 - NZH - Harris endorsement comes Swift> - § 1 reference coded [6.38% Coverage]

Reference 1 - 6.38% Coverage

Swift said she had seen fake AI (artificial intelligence) images of her â€œfalsely endorsing Donald Trumpâ€™s presidential runâ€ , which Trump reposted on Truth Social.
â€œIt really conjured up my fears around AI, and the dangers of spreading misinformation. It brought me to the conclusion that I need to be very transparent about my actual plans for this election as a voter,â€ she said. â€œThe simplest way to combat misinformation is with the truth.â€

<Files\\Processed x Highly relevant\\2025-01-30 - PRS - Warning on China spy risk from> - § 5 references coded [24.36% Coverage]

Reference 1 - 2.51% Coverage

Leading cybersecurity firm CyberCX has warned Kiwi clients that AI tool DeepSeek, which roiled global markets, could enable the Chinese Communist Party to harvest sensitive data. So

Reference 2 - 3.22% Coverage

The firm had assessed that DeepSeek was subject to control by the Chinese government and â€œcollects user personal information from their device and collects prompt information entered by users and stores this information in Chinaâ€ .

Reference 3 - 7.08% Coverage

â€œThereâ€™s a whole raft of issues at play here,â€ said Dan Richardson, CyberCX executive director for strategy and risk.
â€œOf course, the ongoing geo-strategic situation vis-a-vis China has a direct impact on New Zealand and Australia and our institutions and organisations. In particular with DeepSeek, any user generated prompts for that AI tool will end up in a database or data repository based out of China, along with potentially other data that would would be housed on a person's mobile device.â€
Th

Reference 4 - 3.07% Coverage

CyberCX has assessed that the app collected â€œextensive technical information about usersâ€™ devices and networkâ€ , and Richardson said there were â€œsome indicationsâ€ the tool could access further data from devices.
â

Reference 5 - 8.48% Coverage

â€œOur understanding or assessment is this may extend to influencing technology designer standards, and accessing data held in the private sector, and potentially exploiting any remote access to devices enjoyed by Chinese companies that they may leverage for legitimate purposes. If you look at the track record of those Chinese intelligence agencies, they are very interested in unique intellectual property that organisations will hold, so there is a risk that downloading and using this AI assistant on a device that also holds data that is sensitive or commercially sensitive, there is a risk to that data.â€
R

<Files\\Processed x Highly relevant\\2025-03-01 - SCP - MPs Instructed To Remove Four> - § 2 references coded [5.01% Coverage]

Reference 1 - 2.49% Coverage

"Based on this information, and our cybersecurity analysis, the Parliamentary Service Commission determined that the risks [posed by these applications] are not acceptable in the current New Zealand parliamentary environment."
N

Reference 2 - 2.52% Coverage

Some Western nations have raised concern the Chinese government can access sensitive user data through apps such as TikTok. However, TikTok has denied that data or algorithms can be accessed or manipulated by Chinese authorities.
P

<Files\\Processed x Highly relevant\\2025-03-20 - RNZ - Military robots and thinking t> - § 1 reference coded [1.91% Coverage]

Reference 1 - 1.91% Coverage

The SIS spy agency has assessed "emerging technologies" like AI and quantum computing - which are part of the AUKUS Pillar Two tech-sharing pact between the UK, UK and Australia - "are being leveraged by states for strategic purposes, including for espionage, cyber-attacks and dis-information".

<Files\\Processed x Highly relevant\\2025-04-07 - PRS - Will AI replace local politici> - § 1 reference coded [1.81% Coverage]

Reference 1 - 1.81% Coverage

â€˜â€˜People talk about â€˜big brother watching usâ€™, but I like to bring it back to making good decisions.â€™â€™

<Files\\Processed x Highly relevant\\2025-04-07 - RNZ - Bougainville president condemn> - § 4 references coded [17.30% Coverage]

Reference 1 - 3.59% Coverage

Autonomous Bougainville Government President Ishmael Toroama has condemned the circulation of an artificial intelligence (AI)generated video depicting a physical confrontation between him and Papua New Guinea Prime Minister James Marape.

Reference 2 - 1.93% Coverage

In a statement on Monday, Toroama said such content could have a negative impact on Bougainville's efforts toward independence.

Reference 3 - 6.16% Coverage

He said the "reckless misuse of artificial intelligence and social media platforms has the potential to damage the hard-earned trust and mutual respect" between the two nations. "This video is not only false and malicious - it is dangerous," the ABG leader said.
"It threatens to undermine the ongoing spirit of dialogue, peace, and cooperation that both our governments have worked tirelessly to build."

Reference 4 - 5.63% Coverage

He said that while freedom of expression was a democratic value, it was also a privilege that carries responsibilities. He said freedom of expression should not be twisted through misinformation.
"These freedoms must be exercised with respect for the truth. Misusing AI tools to spread falsehoods

not only discredits individuals but can destabilise entire communities."

<Files\\Processed x Highly relevant\\2025-04-24 - NZH - Australian senators warning to> - § 2 references coded [22.68% Coverage]

Reference 1 - 5.59% Coverage

An Australian senator says AI is posing a threat to democracy in the Australian election and should serve as a warning to New Zealand as well.
Deepfakes â€" AI-generated images, video or audio that produce realistic simulations of someone saying or doing something they are not â€" have become increasingly common in elections around the world.

Reference 2 - 17.09% Coverage

â€œIt could be produced by our domestic political opponents, or it could be produced by players outside of the Australian jurisdiction, [like] those backed by the fossil fuel industry who want to prevent Australian politics taking significant action,â€ he said.
Last year, a deepfake impersonating then-US President Joe Biden told thousands of voters in the US state of New Hampshire not to vote in the upcoming primaries.
Leading parties in Indiaâ€™s election also created deepfakes of each other. One portrayed the daughter of a militant leader as a middle-aged woman encouraging Tamils to fight for their political freedom. The woman died in 2009 at the age of 23.
Abhinav Dhall, associate professor of data science and AI at Melbourneâ€™s Monash University, said deepfake production is no longer reserved for highly skilled programmers or tech giants.
He said there are a lot of apps and open-source tools available, and â€œpretty much anyoneâ€ could use them to do things such as swapping a face in an image or generating a video from an image.

<Files\\Processed x Highly relevant\\2025-04-29 - RNZ - Police trial data extraction t> - § 1 reference coded [4.08% Coverage]

Reference 1 - 4.08% Coverage

The police commissioner ordered the first such tech stocktake in 2020 only after RNZ exposed they had trialled - without proper authorisation - an algorithm that searches social media for face matches, from US firm Clearview AI. The list was later made public under media pressure.